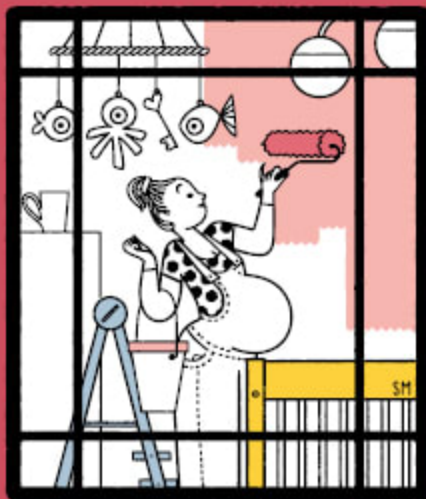


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News

Dems Select Primary for County Board Race as Kanninen Announces Reelection Bid

By **ARLnow.com**

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Arlington County Democratic Committee meeting Jan. 2018 (photo by Kevin Wolf)

Shortly after [electing Jill Caiazzo](#) as its new chair, the Arlington County Democratic Committee selected a County Board primary for 2018.

Last year, the race to select a Democratic nominee to replace retiring County Board member Jay Fisette was [determined by a caucus](#). In [an op-ed](#) last month, Caiazzo said she preferred a primary this year as it encourages more voter participation, while a caucus “is seen by many as rigged in favor of the Democratic establishment.”

Arlington Democrats “voted unanimously to choose this year’s County Board nominee via primary election rather than a caucus in order to achieve greater participation,” according to a press release.

The winner of this year’s Democratic primary is expected to face independent Board member John Vihstadt in the general election.

Also at last night's ACDC meeting, School Board member Barbara Kanninen announced her reelection bid.

From a press release:

In her remarks, Kanninen pointed to a number of accomplishments during her tenure on the School Board over the past four years. "We've worked to support the whole child, to ensure that every child in our schools is healthy, safe, supported, challenged, and engaged," she said. She highlighted increases in academic, social, and emotional assistance; supports for immigrant and LGBTQ students; expansion of STEM programs and career and technical education; and the launch of a strategic planning process to carry Arlington public schools into the 21st century.

"We've done so much together," Kanninen said, "but there is still more to do. I'm running for re-election to continue building up the whole child, I'm running to support the voices of our teachers and staff, and I'm running to support our growth and build a stronger, more responsive school system."

First elected to the School Board in 2014, Kanninen is an environmental economist, children's book author, and community activist. In 2017, Washingtonian magazine named her one of the Most Powerful Women in Washington—the only elected official in Arlington and the only school board member in the DC metro area named to the magazine's list. As a member of the school board, she was awarded the 2015 AGLA Equality Award and the Public Outreach and Engagement Award from the Virginia Chapter of the American Planning Association. Kanninen and her husband have lived in Arlington for 25 years and have two sons who were both K-12 Arlington Public Schools students.

In her speech to the assembled partisans, Caiazzo encouraged local Democrats to avoid complacency and continue fighting for progress.

"The Trump era represents a pivotal moment for the Democratic Party," she said. "With progressive policies under attack daily, we have much to fight against — but we also must demonstrate that we have a positive, solutions-oriented vision that is worth fighting for."

The dynamic and talented members of the Arlington Democrats are ready to meet this challenge.”

Photos by Kevin Wolf

About the Author



[ARLnow.com](https://arlnow.com)

Launched in January 2010, ARLnow.com is the place for the latest news, views and things to do around Arlington, Virginia. The ARLnow staff byline is used for the Morning Notes and reporting done by an editor or other member of our full-time staff.

#Barbara Kanninen

#Democratic Party

#election

#primary



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October 18, 2026
7:30 am-12:00 pm

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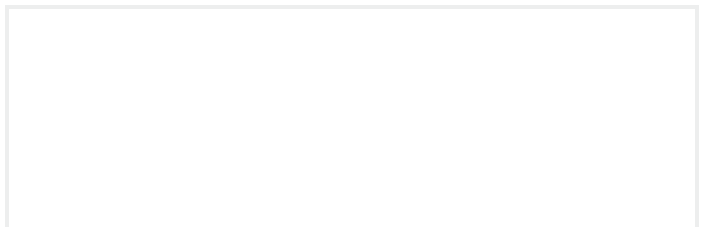
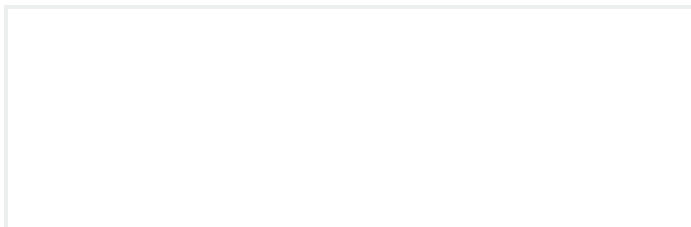


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